Sentences & Clauses (Set B)

Year 4 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked Example: Classify this sentence as simple, compound or complex, and justify your answer: 'Because the storm knocked out the power, the whole street went dark.'

Answer: Complex — it has one subordinate clause ('Because the storm knocked out the power', which cannot stand alone) and one main clause ('the whole street went dark', which can).

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Is this a simple sentence? 'The librarian stamped the book.' Explain your answer.
2. Identify the main clause in: 'The baby giggled happily.'
3. Which sentence below is a simple sentence? A) It snowed, and school closed. B) It snowed. C) When it snowed, school closed. D) It snowed because the temperature dropped. E) Although it was summer, it snowed.
4. Join these two simple sentences into one compound sentence using 'and': 'The oven beeped. Dad took out the pie.'
5. Underline the subordinate clause: 'Although it was dark, they kept walking.'
6. Underline the main clause: 'Although it was dark, they kept walking.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are coordinating conjunctions used to build compound sentences? A) but B) since C) or D) and E) unless
8. Write one simple sentence about a school trip.
9. Which sentence is a compound sentence? A) The lights dimmed. B) The lights dimmed because of the storm. C) The lights dimmed, and then the power failed. D) When the storm hit, the lights dimmed. E) The dimming lights flickered.
10. Join these two sentences with 'but' to make a compound sentence: 'She studied hard. She still found the test difficult.'
11. Identify the subject and the verb in this simple sentence: 'The crowd roared.'
12. In 'The bus was delayed, so we arrived late for assembly,' which word joins the two main clauses? A) was B) delayed C) so D) arrived E) late
13. Write a compound sentence of your own using the conjunction 'or'.
14. Explain why 'Jumping over puddles' is NOT a complete sentence.
15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are complete simple sentences? A) The owl hooted. B) Behind the shed. C) Rain fell steadily. D) Although it was late. E) The gate creaked.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. In 'When the whistle blew, the players stopped immediately,' identify the subordinate clause and the main clause.
2. Which sentence below is a complex sentence? A) The fog lifted, and the sun shone. B) The fog lifted. C) Although the fog lifted, it stayed cold. D) The fog lifted; the sun shone. E) The fog and the mist lifted.
3. Combine these two sentences into a complex sentence using 'although': 'He was nervous. He gave the speech.'

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4. Identify the subordinating conjunction in: 'Since the library closed early, we studied at home instead.'

5. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause, using an example of your own.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences are complex sentences? A) If the bus is late, we will walk. B) The bus was late, and we walked. C) We walked because the bus was late. D) The bus arrived on time today. E) Although the bus was late, we waited.

7. Rewrite 'The thunder rumbled. The lights flickered.' as one compound sentence using a semicolon instead of a conjunction.

8. Which word begins the subordinate clause in 'Unless we leave now, we will be late'? A) Unless B) we C) leave D) will E) be

9. Explain why 'Before the match began' is a subordinate clause and not a complete sentence on its own.

10. Write a complex sentence that starts with the subordinating conjunction 'Because'.

11. Identify the two main clauses in this compound sentence: 'The gardener planted the seeds, and the rain watered them.'

12. Which sentence correctly uses a comma after a fronted subordinate clause? A) Although tired she carried on. B) Although tired, she carried on. C) Although, tired she carried on. D) Although tired she, carried on. E) Although tired she carried, on.

13. Turn this simple sentence into a complex sentence by adding a subordinate clause beginning with 'while': 'Mum read a story.'

14. Explain why 'The bike that I borrowed broke down' is a complex sentence, identifying the main and subordinate clauses.

15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words can begin a subordinate clause? A) since B) or C) unless D) yet E) when

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Is "Having packed her bags quickly" a full sentence, and why or why not?

2. In "The teacher, calm but firm, dismissed the class," is "calm but firm" a clause or a phrase, and how can you tell?

3. Find the conjunction in "The storm passed quickly, yet the roads stayed flooded," and say whether the sentence is compound or complex.

4. Is "The quick fox and the lazy dog slept in the sun" simple or compound, and why?

5. What type of sentence is "Wait!", and what is its subject?

6. Read: "Before the sun rose, the fishermen cast their nets." Identify the subordinate clause and the main clause.

7. Rewrite this pair of simple sentences as one complex sentence, then as one compound sentence: "The siren sounded. Workers left the building."

8. Which part of this sentence is the relative clause? "The tower, which had been built long ago, finally crumbled." A) The tower B) which had been built long ago C) finally crumbled D) The tower finally crumbled

9. Is this sentence compound, complex or simple? "Even though she trained every day, she did not win." A) simple B) compound C) complex D) none of these

10. Write your own complex sentence about a rainy day, then underline the subordinate clause.

11. Read: "The gymnast still competed because her injury had healed." Find the main clause and the subordinate clause.

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12. Combine these two simple sentences into one complex sentence: "The gates opened early. A long queue formed outside."

13. Which sentence below correctly uses a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The storm passed; the sun came out. B) The storm passed, the sun came out. C) The storm passed: the sun came out. D) The storm passed the sun came out.

14. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following are COMPLEX sentences (one main clause plus one subordinate clause)? A) Although it was dark, they kept walking. B) The gate creaked loudly. C) Because the fog was thick, the ferry waited. D) She read, and he listened. E) The painting, which hung there, was priceless.

15. What is the difference in meaning between these two sentences? "The painting that hung in the hall was priceless." and "The painting, which hung in the hall, was priceless." A) No difference in meaning B) First: only one painting (the one that hung there) is meant; second: adds extra detail about an already-known painting C) First means many paintings were priceless D) Second means no painting was priceless

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